

# Nelson Mandela

The man who gave AFRICA  
back to its people

Mandela fought long and hard against apartheid in South Africa, and spent 27 years in prison, before he was voted the country's first black president.

## Young activist

Rolihlahla Mandela was born in Transkei, South Africa, in 1918, and was later given the name **Nelson** by his teacher. After he qualified as a lawyer he became involved with a group trying to bring about *political change* in South Africa, called the **AFRICAN NATIONAL CONGRESS (ANC)**.



## The fight for freedom

In 1948, the white South African government brought in "apartheid" laws that meant that white and black people had to stay **SEPARATE**. Mandela became deputy leader of the ANC, and they started peaceful protests. But, after police killed 69 protestors, the ANC became more *violent*. The government banned the ANC and Mandela was **arrested** for plotting against the government. In 1964, he was sentenced to **LIFE IMPRISONMENT**.



He couldn't have done it without...

In prison, Mandela was inspired by **WILLIAM HENLEY's** (1849–1903) poem **INVICTUS**: "I am the master of my fate, I am the captain of my soul."



South Africa's first black Archbishop **DESMOND TUTU** (1931–) was, like Mandela, an extremely passionate anti-apartheid **CAMPAIGNER**.

